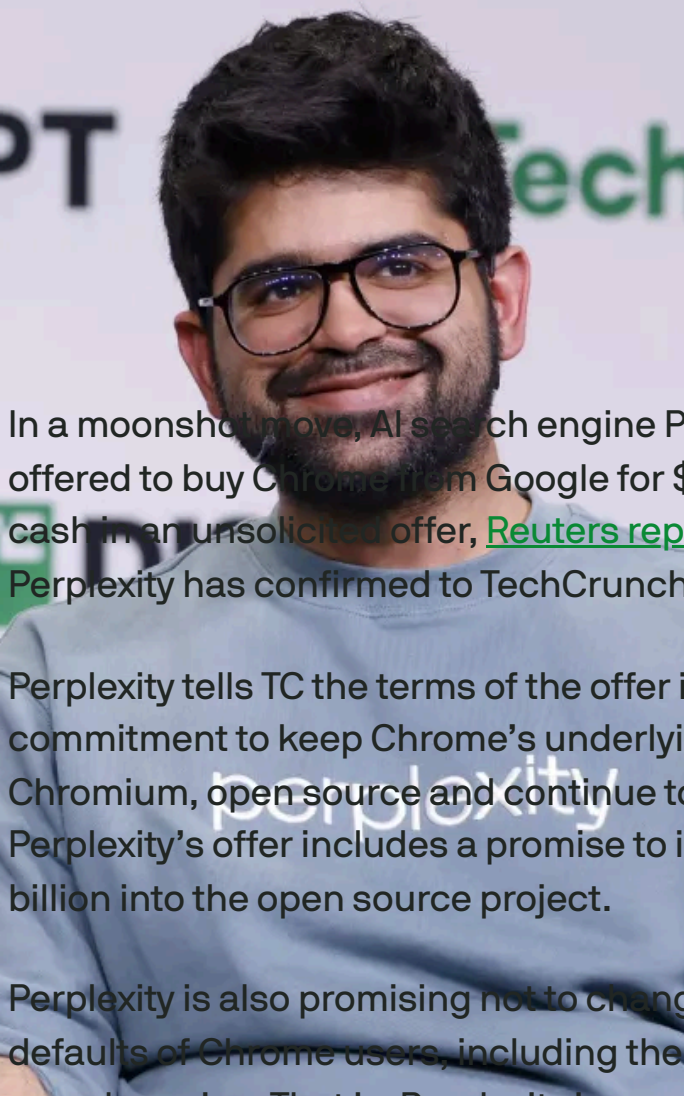


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Perplexity offers to buy
Chrome for billions more
than it's raised



In a moonshot move, AI search engine Perplexity has offered to buy Chrome from Google for \$34.5 billion cash in an unsolicited offer, [Reuters reported](#), and Perplexity has confirmed to TechCrunch.

Perplexity tells TC the terms of the offer include a commitment to keep Chrome's underlying engine, Chromium, open source and continue to invest in it. Perplexity's offer includes a promise to invest \$3 billion into the open source project.

Perplexity is also promising not to change the user defaults of Chrome users, including the default search engine. That is, Perplexity is promising to leave Google as the search engine rather than making its own AI-powered option the default.

Google could not be reached for comment. TechCrunch will update the article if the company responds.

This bid comes after the Department of Justice proposed in March that [Google be forced to sell Chrome](#) after a judge [ruled the tech giant acted illegally](#) to maintain a monopoly in online search. Google has not agreed to sell Chrome and has vowed to fight the ruling.

The Perplexity spokesperson believes the court will soon set terms for remedies, perhaps later this month. (Google is also fighting [another federal case where the judge ruled it illegally](#) monopolized

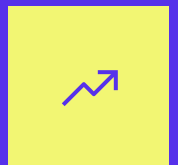
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adtech, and the DOJ is proposing Google be forced to divest two of its adtech products or otherwise break up its ad business.)

When the DOJ first proposed that Google divest Chrome, [both OpenAI](#) and [Perplexity](#) expressed interest in buying it. Given that Chrome is the dominant browser, with 68% marketshare [according to Statcounter](#), if the court rules Chrome must be sold, no doubt others worldwide would want to bid as well.

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Interestingly, the CEO of rival search engine DuckDuckGo testified in April that Chrome could be worth “upwards of \$50 billion,” [Bloomberg reported at the time](#). Should Perplexity's offer succeed, it could be considered a bargain.

Still, this offer for Chrome is far more than Perplexity has raised from investors and more than the startup's current valuation. Perplexity has raised about \$1.5 billion to date, PitchBook estimates, including an extension round of \$100 million raised

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last month that valued it at \$18 billion, [Bloomberg reported](#).

In the meantime, Perplexity last month [launched its own browser, called Comet](#), in its bid to grow its AI search business without having to serve its customers through a browser, particularly one owned by its main rival Google.

And, by the way, last month, Perplexity also reportedly [submitted a bid to merge with TikTok](#).

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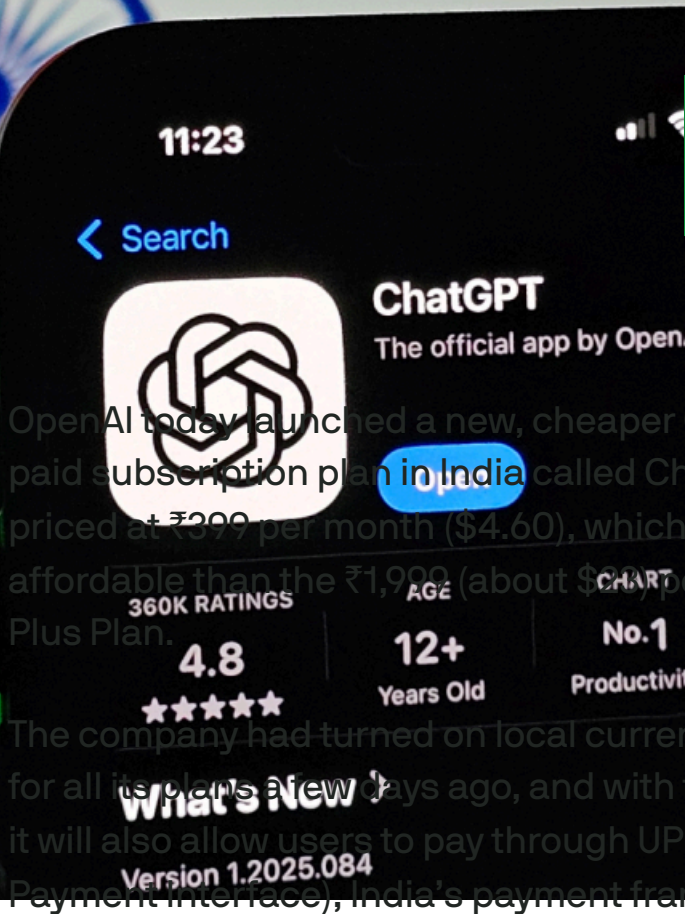
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OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta — 8:57 PM PDT · August 18, 2025



OpenAI today launched a new, cheaper ChatGPT paid subscription plan in India called ChatGPT GO, priced at ₹399 per month (\$4.60), which is more affordable than the ₹1,999 (about \$24) per month Plus Plan.

The company had turned on local currency pricing for all its plans a few days ago, and with this launch, it will also allow users to pay through UPI (Unified Payment Interface), India's payment framework.

IMAGE CREDITS: JAGMEET SINGH / TECHCRUNCH

Nick Turley, VP at OpenAI and head of ChatGPT, said that this plan will increase the message, image generation, and file uploads by 10 times over the free tier. The ChatGPT Go plan will also enable better memory retention for more personalized responses, Turley said.

We just launched ChatGPT Go in India, a new subscription tier that gives users in India more access to our most popular features: 10x higher message limits, 10x more image generations, 10x more file uploads, and 2x longer memory compared with our free tier. All for Rs. 399. 🇮🇳

— Nick Turley (@nickaturley) [August 19, 2025](#)

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“Making ChatGPT more affordable has been a key ask from users! We’re rolling out Go in India first and will learn from feedback before expanding to other countries,” Turley said.

From a currency conversion standpoint, the Plus plan was higher than \$20 for Indian users when offered in local currency. The new Go plan offers a more affordable alternative to people who are looking to use ChatGPT primarily for chat, image generation, and file processing.

Tibor Blaho, a software engineer with a reputation for accurately leaking upcoming AI products, had [previously teased](#) this plan and its details.

While the company is geo-restricting this plan to India, the company said on its [support page](#) that it is working to expand this plan to more regions.



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Last month, Turley noted that ChatGPT now has more than [700 million weekly users](#) worldwide — up from 500 million in March. OpenAI launched its

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updated image generator feature for ChatGPT in March, [and since then, it has seen an uptick in usage in India](#). OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said in a recent podcast that India is [the company's second biggest market](#). With the Go plan, it wants to cash in on that.

According to app analytics firm AppFigures, India has been the leading country in terms of ChatGPT app downloads across platforms, with over 29 million downloads coming from the country in the last 90 days. However, the app only made \$3.6 million in this period from users in the country.

This move will likely nudge more consumers to subscribe to using ChatGPT more, given its pricing. Other AI companies have also made moves to attract users from the country's internet user base of over 850 million. Last month, Perplexity partnered with network provider Airtel to offer [free Perplexity Pro subscriptions](#). Google also dished up [a free AI Pro plan for India-based students for one year](#).

While OpenAI's move is not giving out any freebies, local and affordable pricing will likely result in a better subscription conversion rate for ChatGPT in India.

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Why Paradigm built a spreadsheet with an AI agent in every cell

Rebecca Szkutak — 8:00 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Anna Monaco has been building AI agents since before the term “AI agents” was even a thing. After

building numerous chatbots, she started looking for other types of interfaces that made sense for AI agents and landed on spreadsheets.

“I had this personal pattern, and I noticed that a lot of other people had this pattern, of putting very important CRM data in spreadsheets just because it was the most flexible thing,” Monaco told TechCrunch. “But it was actually a pain to maintain. There’s so much manual work involved. So [I] just went down this rabbit hole of building a product for myself and wanted to reimagine what a spreadsheet could look like with the full power of LLMs.”

The result was [Paradigm](#), an AI-powered spreadsheet equipped with more than 5,000 AI agents. Users can assign different prompts to individual columns and cells, and individual AI agents will crawl the internet to find and fill out the needed information.

Paradigm works with AI models from Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google’s Gemini, Monaco said, and supports model switching.

“We want to support every single model because we want our users to be able to have the highest reasoning outputs when they need it, but also the cheapest outputs,” Monaco said. “It’s just a constant cycle of evaluating different models, working closely with model providers to make sure our limits are high enough, and then giving some of that power to our users.”

The company launched a small closed beta preview in late 2024 and has been iterating on the product using customer feedback. Paradigm attracts users ranging from consultants to sales professionals and finance folks and operates on a subscription model with tiers based on usage. Paradigm counts the consulting firm EY, AI chip startup Etched, and AI coding company Cognition as early customers.

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Paradigm is now releasing its product to the public and announcing that it raised a \$5 million seed round led by General Catalyst. The company has raised \$7 million to date. Monaco said the funding will go toward executing on the company's "extremely aggressive product roadmap."



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"The interesting thing that happened when we fundraised is some people we pitched just kept on using and paying for the product," Monaco said. "I think that was a cool part of it. We found a lot of value from it internally and our investors, not even just our investors — other investors that we talked to — are still using it."

Paradigm isn't the only company looking to give spreadsheets an AI upgrade. [Quadratic](#), which has raised more than \$6 million in venture funding, is a 3-year-old startup with a similar goal. Legacy companies like Google and Microsoft are also adding AI tools to their spreadsheet applications.

Monaco said that she doesn't really consider the competition because Denmark doesn't think of

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Rebecca Szkutak

Senior Reporter, Venture | [in](#)

Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the...

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SECURITY



HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach

Zack Whittaker — 6:04 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

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Workday, one of the largest providers of human resources technology, has confirmed a data breach that allowed hackers to steal personal information from one of its third-party customer relationship databases.

In [a blog post published late Friday](#), the HR technology giant said the hackers stole an unspecified amount of personal information from the database, which Workday said was primarily used to store contact information, such as names, email addresses, and phone numbers.

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Workday did not explicitly rule out that customer information was taken in the data breach, stating only that there was “no indication of access to customer tenants or the data within them,” which corporate customers typically use to store the bulk of their human resources files and employees’ personal data.

The company said the stolen information may be used to further social engineering scams, where hackers trick or threaten victims into giving them access to sensitive data.

Workday has more than 11,000 corporate customers, serving at least 70 million users around the world, [per the company’s website](#). Bleeping Computer [reports](#) that the hack was discovered on August 6.

Workday did not identify the breached third-party customer database platform, but follows in a recent spate of cyberattacks targeting Salesforce-hosted databases used by large companies to store customer data. In recent weeks, [Google](#), [Cisco](#), [airline giant Qantas](#), and [retailer Pandora](#) have all had reams of data stolen from their Salesforce databases.

Google attributed the breaches to ShinyHunters, a group of hackers known for using voice phishing to steal corporate data by tricking company employees into granting them access to their cloud-based databases. Google said ShinyHunters was likely in the process of preparing a data leak site to extort its victims into paying the hackers to delete the data, akin to how ransomware gangs operate.

Connor Spielmaker, a spokesperson for Workday, did not comment beyond Workday’s blog post or answer TechCrunch’s questions, including whether Workday knows how many individuals had data stolen or who the stolen data relates to, such as

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Workday employees or Workday's corporate customers. Workday would not say if it has the technical means, such as logs, to determine what customer data was exfiltrated.

As of the time of publication, Workday's blog post [disclosing the breach](#) contained a hidden "noindex" tag in its source code, which instructs search engines to ignore the page, making it difficult for anyone searching the web to find the page.

It's not clear for what reason Workday is hiding its data breach notification from search engines.

Do you know more about the Workday data breach or attacks targeting Salesforce databases? Have you been notified about a data breach? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Updated with a response from Workday.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

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Zack Whittaker

Security Editor |



Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337...](#)

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Made by Google 2025: How to watch Google debut the Pixel 10, Pixel Watch 4, and more

Lauren Forristal — 9:22 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Google is scheduled to host its Made by Google event, [broadcast on its Made by Google YouTube channel](#), at 10 a.m. PT Wednesday. The tech giant is anticipated to [unveil the new Pixel 10 series](#), and we'll also likely see the Pixel Watch 4, new earbuds, and possibly AI features.

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Before the event starts, the video will also be embedded here in this article. As usual, TechCrunch will provide updates as they happen.

10 generations in the making.

Look for [#Pixel10](#) in 10 days at [#MadeByGoogle](#): <https://t.co/VxzWRaYodH>
[pic.twitter.com/ER8qtFcDv5](https://t.co/VxzWRaYodH)

— Made by Google (@madebygoogle) [August 10, 2025](#)

The main attraction is expected to be the new Pixel 10 series, which will include the standard model, the Pixel 10 Pro, the Pixel 10 Pro XL, and the foldable Pixel 10 Pro Fold.

There are also rumors that Google will reveal the Pixel Watch 4, which could feature longer battery life and faster charging. New earbuds, such as a refreshed Pixel Buds 2a, might also be on the horizon.

Additionally, we may get more AI features for the Pixel 10 as Google ramps up its efforts to focus [on its family of Gemini models](#).

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Lauren Forristal



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